

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3346

Name
Hugo Ducret
Email
hugo.ducret@ulb.be
Gender
Male
Residence: City (State), Country
Watermael-Boitsfort, Belgium
Nationality
French
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
October 2025
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
I see myself as a generalist, early-career marine biologist with various research interests, from molecular ecology to conservation biology. My research currently focuses on coral reefs ecology and photobiology. Through this exciting scientific journey between the Université libre de Bruxelles (Brussels, Belgium) and the Hawai'i institute of Marine Biology (HIMB, Kaneohe, Hawai'i), I found myself learning skills and expertise in various research disciplines and methods, from extensive field missions at the HIMB coral nursery, to the use of Nanopore Technologies (ONT) sequencing tools, and the analysis of heavy biological datasets.
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
I see this fellowship as a unique opportunity to join a project that can have a direct and positive impact on communities. I have always been passionate about science outreach, and wanted to join such a project for a long while. Combining biology with education is a challenge that I am willing to take, as I am certain that I will learn as much as the students that I would be teaching. Being immersed in a different culture is something I have been used to, as my academic journey brought me to Malaysia, Guyana and Hawaii, among others. I know how enriching these opportunities are, and I cannot wait to have a professional experience in the Philippines. I met a former student from this high school, Dina Mae Ranises, she is now a lab mate in Brussels, and we are doing research together. She told me only good things about the high school and the environment in Bohol, which motivates me even more to enroll to this program. Lastly, we have been conducting extensive Nanopore experiments in our lab in Brussels. I have been through most

-if not all- of the tricky technical steps, and would be happy to help setting this up now that we have been through the process.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

I have had a good amount of experience with children earlier on. I have been practicing fencing for about 10 years as a teenager, and this involved coaching and helping younger students during trainings and tournaments.

Additionally, I am regularly helping in science outreach events as a biologist. This involved doing presentations about coral reef ecology to a broad audience, or talk about the human impacts on our shorelines back home.

Finally, during an excursion at the Matang Mangrove Reserve, in Malaysia, I had the opportunity to entertain school activities with the local children, and conduct a two-day science outreach activity. Through playful activities, we conveyed the message that mangrove was worth being protected, and explained the biological notion of ecosystem services. We did games, drawings, or songs related to ecology in a broad sense. This tricky exercise was a very enriching experience of disseminating science to a non-expert audience.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia

In science education

In science outreach

Other

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

Besides my Ph.D. project, I have a deep interest in ethnobiology. Spending time in Hawai'i as an ecologist made me familiar with the basics of traditional Hawaiian land knowledge systems, such as the concepts of 'āina, and ahupua'a. This sharpened my sensitivity to traditional ecological knowledges of other people and parts of the world. I ultimately wish to combine ethnobiology with research in biology and ecology to tackle conservation issues. This implies staying in science, particularly academia, but extending research to something more interdisciplinary. On the long term, I would be thrilled to work closely with NGOs, schools, and policy makers on top of scientists.

Please upload your CV (.pdf)

 [CV_HUGO_DUCRET.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia

[Science Corps](#)